

POPULATION AND ASSOCIATED ISSUES

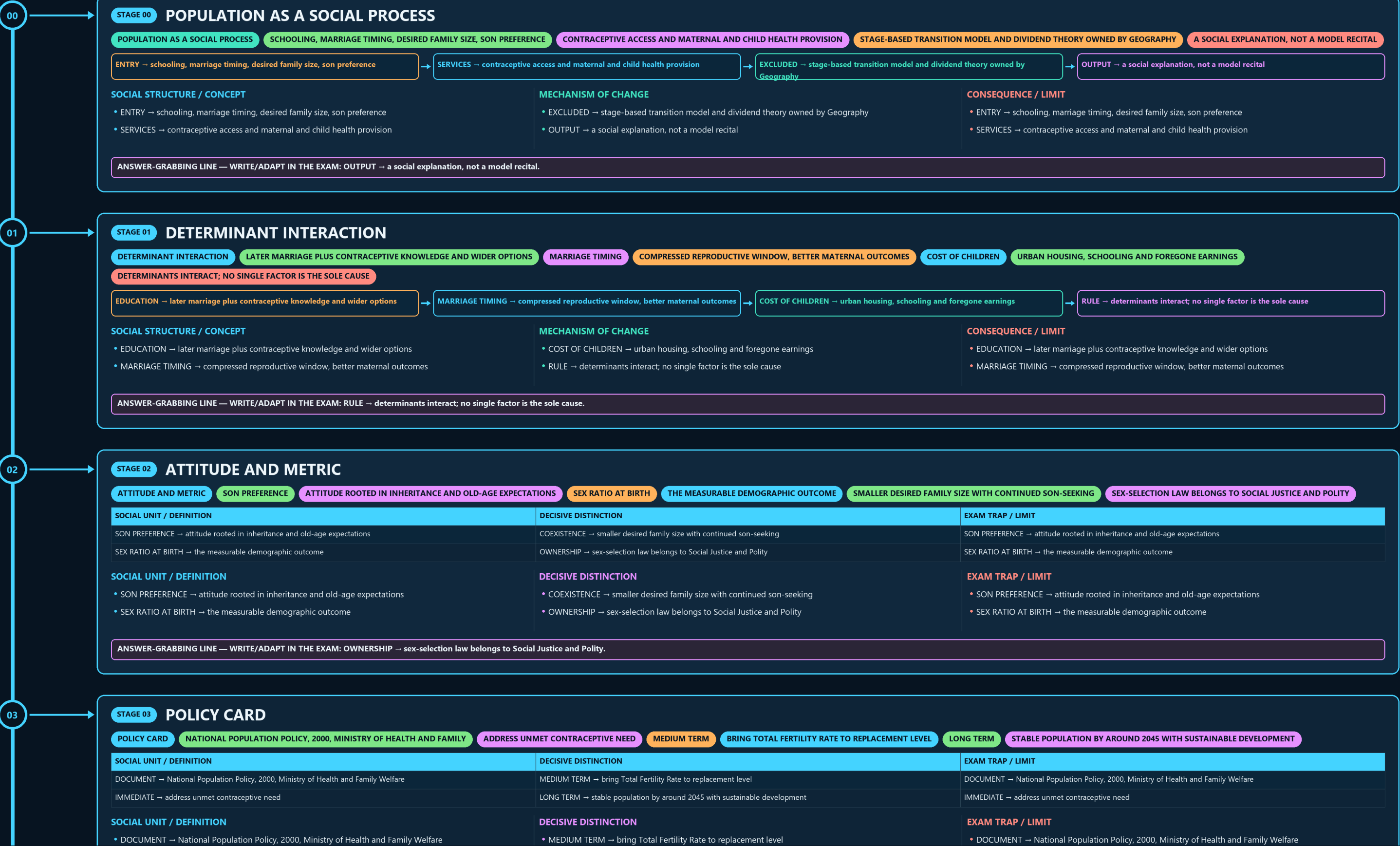
POPULATION AS A SOCIAL → DETERMINANT INTERACTION → ATTITUDE AND METRIC → POLICY CARD → EVIDENCE-STATUS LADDER → AGGREGATE AGAINST DIVERGENCE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

SON PREFERENCE → attitude rooted in inheritance and old-age expectations

SEX RATIO AT BIRTH → the measurable demographic outcome

COEXISTENCE → smaller desired family size with continued son-seeking

OWNERSHIP → sex-selection law belongs to Social Justice and Polity

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OWNERSHIP → sex-selection law belongs to Social Justice and Polity.

03

STAGE 03

POLICY CARD

POLICY CARD

NATIONAL POPULATION POLICY, 2000, MINISTRY OF HEALTH AND FAMILY

ADDRESS UNMET CONTRACEPTIVE NEED

MEDIUM TERM

BRING TOTAL FERTILITY RATE TO REPLACEMENT LEVEL

LONG TERM

STABLE POPULATION BY AROUND 2045 WITH SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

| SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION                                                           | DECISIVE DISTINCTION                                                      | EXAM TRAP / LIMIT                                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DOCUMENT → National Population Policy, 2000, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare | MEDIUM TERM → bring Total Fertility Rate to replacement level             | DOCUMENT → National Population Policy, 2000, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare |
| IMMEDIATE → address unmet contraceptive need                                       | LONG TERM → stable population by around 2045 with sustainable development | IMMEDIATE → address unmet contraceptive need                                       |

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

DOCUMENT → National Population Policy, 2000, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

IMMEDIATE → address unmet contraceptive need

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

MEDIUM TERM → bring Total Fertility Rate to replacement level

LONG TERM → stable population by around 2045 with sustainable development

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

DOCUMENT → National Population Policy, 2000, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

IMMEDIATE → address unmet contraceptive need

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LONG TERM → stable population by around 2045 with sustainable development.

04

STAGE 04

EVIDENCE-STATUS LADDER

EVIDENCE-STATUS LADDER

RELEASED 29 MAY 2026, TOTAL 2.0, URBAN 1.6, RURAL

2019-21 ROUND, TOTAL FERTILITY RATE 2.0, HISTORICAL COMPARATOR

2011 IS THE LAST COMPLETED FULL COUNT; CENSUS 2027

NO SURVEY AVERAGE MAY BE QUOTED AS A STATE

NFHS-6 → released 29 May 2026, total 2.0, urban 1.6, rural 2.1, provisional

NFHS-5 → 2019-21 round, Total Fertility Rate 2.0, historical comparator

CENSUS → 2011 is the last completed full count; Census 2027 is prospective

PROHIBITION → no survey average may be quoted as a state or current stock

| OFFICIAL EVIDENCE / DATE                                                                                                                                                            | WHAT IT PROVES                                                                                                                                                                       | CLAIM LIMIT                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><div>NFHS-6 → released 29 May 2026, total 2.0, urban 1.6, rural 2.1, provisional</div><div>NFHS-5 → 2019-21 round, Total Fertility Rate 2.0, historical comparator</div></div> | <div><div>CENSUS → 2011 is the last completed full count; Census 2027 is prospective</div><div>PROHIBITION → no survey average may be quoted as a state or current stock</div></div> | <div><div>NFHS-6 → released 29 May 2026, total 2.0, urban 1.6, rural 2.1, provisional</div><div>NFHS-5 → 2019-21 round, Total Fertility Rate 2.0, historical comparator</div></div> |

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PROHIBITION → no survey average may be quoted as a state or current stock.

05

STAGE 05

AGGREGATE AGAINST DIVERGENCE

AGGREGATE AGAINST DIVERGENCE

A WEIGHTED SUMMARY OF STATES IN DIFFERENT TRANSITION PHASES

BELOW REPLACEMENT

AGEING PRESSURE AND WORKFORCE-SHRINKAGE RISK

ABOVE REPLACEMENT

YOUNG STRUCTURE WITH AN OPEN DIVIDEND WINDOW

THE HONEST ANSWER IS STATE-GRADED, NOT NATION-UNIFORM

| SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION                                               | DECISIVE DISTINCTION                                             | EXAM TRAP / LIMIT                                                      |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| NATIONAL → a weighted summary of states in different transition phases | ABOVE REPLACEMENT → young structure with an open dividend window | NATIONAL → a weighted summary of states in different transition phases |
| BELOW REPLACEMENT → ageing pressure and workforce-shrinkage risk       | VERDICT → the honest answer is state-graded, not nation-uniform  | BELOW REPLACEMENT → ageing pressure and workforce-shrinkage risk       |

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

NATIONAL → a weighted summary of states in different transition phases

BELOW REPLACEMENT → ageing pressure and workforce-shrinkage risk

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

ABOVE REPLACEMENT → young structure with an open dividend window

VERDICT → the honest answer is state-graded, not nation-uniform

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

NATIONAL → a weighted summary of states in different transition phases

BELOW REPLACEMENT → ageing pressure and workforce-shrinkage risk

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → the honest answer is state-graded, not nation-uniform.

06

STAGE 06

WINTER AND DIVIDEND

WINTER AND DIVIDEND

DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER

SUSTAINED SUB-REPLACEMENT FERTILITY WITH AGEING AND DECLINE

DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND

LARGEST WORKING-AGE SHARE, GROWTH-FAVOURABLE WINDOW

NEAR-OPPOSITE PHASES OF THE SAME TRANSITION

A LARGE COUNTRY CAN DISPLAY BOTH ACROSS ITS REGIONS

| SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION                                                         | DECISIVE DISTINCTION                                          | EXAM TRAP / LIMIT                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER → sustained sub-replacement fertility with ageing and decline | RELATION → near-opposite phases of the same transition        | DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER → sustained sub-replacement fertility with ageing and decline |
| DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND → largest working-age share, growth-favourable window       | CAUTION → a large country can display both across its regions | DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND → largest working-age share, growth-favourable window       |

POPULATION AND ASSOCIATED ISSUES • TILE 2/4 • same master rows 2417-5651 of 10484 • continues below

06

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- NATIONAL → a weighted summary of states in different transition phases
- BELOW REPLACEMENT → ageing pressure and workforce-shrinkage risk

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- ABOVE REPLACEMENT → young structure with an open dividend window
- VERDICT → the honest answer is state-graded, not nation-uniform

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- NATIONAL → a weighted summary of states in different transition phases
- BELOW REPLACEMENT → ageing pressure and workforce-shrinkage risk

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → the honest answer is state-graded, not nation-uniform.

07

STAGE 06 WINTER AND DIVIDEND

WINTER AND DIVIDEND

DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER

SUSTAINED SUB-REPLACEMENT FERTILITY WITH AGEING AND DECLINE

DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND

LARGEST WORKING-AGE SHARE, GROWTH-FAVOURABLE WINDOW

NEAR-OPPOSITE PHASES OF THE SAME TRANSITION

A LARGE COUNTRY CAN DISPLAY BOTH ACROSS ITS REGIONS

| SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION                                                         | DECISIVE DISTINCTION                                          | EXAM TRAP / LIMIT                                                                |
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SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER → sustained sub-replacement fertility with ageing and decline
- DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND → largest working-age share, growth-favourable window

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- RELATION → near-opposite phases of the same transition
- CAUTION → a large country can display both across its regions

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER → sustained sub-replacement fertility with ageing and decline
- DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND → largest working-age share, growth-favourable window

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION → a large country can display both across its regions.

08

STAGE 07 AGEING DOUBLE READING

AGEING DOUBLE READING

LONGER LIFE FROM SUCCESSFUL MORTALITY AND HEALTH TRANSITION

RISING OLD-AGE DEPENDENCY AND WORKFORCE RECOMPOSITION

FAMILY-BASED CARE WEAKENED BY NUCLEARISATION

FORMAL OLD-AGE SECURITY NOT YET SCALED WHERE FERTILITY FELL

| SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION                                                  | DECISIVE DISTINCTION                                                       | EXAM TRAP / LIMIT                                                         |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ACHIEVEMENT → longer life from successful mortality and health transition | SUPPORT → family-based care weakened by nuclearisation                     | ACHIEVEMENT → longer life from successful mortality and health transition |
| BURDEN → rising old-age dependency and workforce recomposition            | GAP → formal old-age security not yet scaled where fertility fell earliest | BURDEN → rising old-age dependency and workforce recomposition            |

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- ACHIEVEMENT → longer life from successful mortality and health transition
- BURDEN → rising old-age dependency and workforce recomposition

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- SUPPORT → family-based care weakened by nuclearisation
- GAP → formal old-age security not yet scaled where fertility fell earliest

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- ACHIEVEMENT → longer life from successful mortality and health transition
- BURDEN → rising old-age dependency and workforce recomposition

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GAP → formal old-age security not yet scaled where fertility fell earliest.

09

STAGE 08 TWO TRANSITION FRAMEWORKS

TWO TRANSITION FRAMEWORKS

FIRST TRANSITION

MORTALITY DECLINE FOLLOWED BY FERTILITY DECLINE

SECOND TRANSITION

VALUE AND FAMILY-FORMATION SHIFT BELOW REPLACEMENT

THE SECOND FRAMEWORK IS LARGELY EUROPEAN IN DERIVATION

AN ANALYTICAL LENS, NEVER AN ESTABLISHED INDIAN DIAGNOSIS

FIRST TRANSITION → mortality decline followed by fertility decline

→

SECOND TRANSITION → value and family-formation shift below replacement

→

ORIGIN → the second framework is largely European in derivation

→

STATUS → an analytical lens, never an established Indian diagnosis

| SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT                                                                                                                                                                        | MECHANISM OF CHANGE                                                                                                                                                                        | CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT                                                                                                                                                                               |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>FIRST TRANSITION → mortality decline followed by fertility decline</li><li>SECOND TRANSITION → value and family-formation shift below replacement</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>ORIGIN → the second framework is largely European in derivation</li><li>STATUS → an analytical lens, never an established Indian diagnosis</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>FIRST TRANSITION → mortality decline followed by fertility decline</li><li>SECOND TRANSITION → value and family-formation shift below replacement</li></ul> |

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SECOND TRANSITION → value and family-formation shift below replacement.

09

STAGE 09 MIGRATION OFFSET

MIGRATION OFFSET

RECEIVING REGION

WORKING-AGE INFLOW CUSHIONS WORKFORCE SHRINKAGE

SENDING REGION

ELDERLY PARENTS LEFT WITH THINNER HOUSEHOLD SUPPORT

NET EFFECT

THE AGEING PROBLEM IS REDISTRIBUTED, NOT REMOVED

ANSWER USE

RECEIVING REGION → working-age inflow cushions workforce shrinkage

→

SENDING REGION → elderly parents left with thinner household support

→

NET EFFECT → the ageing problem is redistributed, not removed

→

ANSWER USE → state the regional trade-off before recommending mobility

| SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT                                                                                                                                                                      | MECHANISM OF CHANGE                                                                                                                                                                          | CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>RECEIVING REGION → working-age inflow cushions workforce shrinkage</li><li>SENDING REGION → elderly parents left with thinner household support</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>NET EFFECT → the ageing problem is redistributed, not removed</li><li>ANSWER USE → state the regional trade-off before recommending mobility</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>RECEIVING REGION → working-age inflow cushions workforce shrinkage</li><li>SENDING REGION → elderly parents left with thinner household support</li></ul> |

POPULATION AND ASSOCIATED ISSUES • TILE 3/4 • same master rows 4833-8067 of 10484 • continues below

- FIRST TRANSITION → mortality decline followed by fertility decline
- SECOND TRANSITION → value and family-formation shift below replacement

## ANSWER USE

➡ **ANSWER USE** → state the regional trade-off before recommending mobility

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- RECEIVING REGION → working-age inflow cushions workforce shrinkage
- SENDING REGION → elderly parents left with thinner household support

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**CAPABILITY BUILDING, NEVER A DEMOGRAPHIC TARGET**

➡ **SAFEGUARD** → capability building, never a demographic target

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CONTENT → age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting instruction
- OBJECTIVES → health information, gender equality, voluntary choice, resource awareness

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### GRADED VERDICT WITH THE SURVEY-VERSUS-CENSUS CAVEAT

➤ **CLOSE** → graded verdict with the survey-versus-census caveat

### CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- OPEN → define the term precisely and name the social mechanism
- BODY → dated anchor, then immediate disaggregation by state

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### BOUNDARY CASE 1 — LOCALISED DEMOGRAPHIC WINTER

### A STATE WITH TFR STILL ABOVE

## COMPARATIVE SOCIAL NUANCE